

ALL IN THE FAMILY

Tracey Noonan and her daughter, Danielle, sure know how to make an impression. Their product, Wicked Good Cupcakes, first became a media sensation in December of 2011, when a woman had her cupcakes-in-a-jar confiscated by Boston airport security. The transport security officer claimed the unusually “thick layer of icing” posed a risk to national safety. The official response from Wicked Good Cupcakes? “Apparently, we’re a tasty terrorist threat.”

Fast-forward two years to when I met Tracey and Dani on the set of *Shark Tank*. They were a feisty mother-daughter duo, clearly excited about their product and with the sales to back it up. Dani looked like a young Joan Jett—covered in tattoos, wearing big, dangly earrings, very punk. The Wicked Good origin story went like this: two years earlier, Danielle had moved out of the house, and Tracey suggested they take a cake-decorating class to spend more time together. Together they discovered a mutual love of (and talent for making) cupcakes, and—voilà—a business was born. Tracey’s husband, Scott, built the website and handled the tech side of things, so it truly was a family business.

Of course, it won’t surprise you to hear I cared more about the numbers than the feel-good family story. When Tracey and Dani made their pitch, they had sold \$150,000 worth of cupcakes from